

Developer Workforce & Compensation Trends

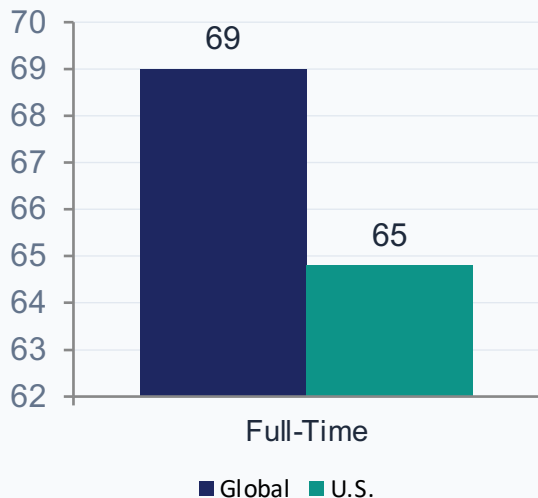
2024 Stack Overflow Survey

65,437 respondents

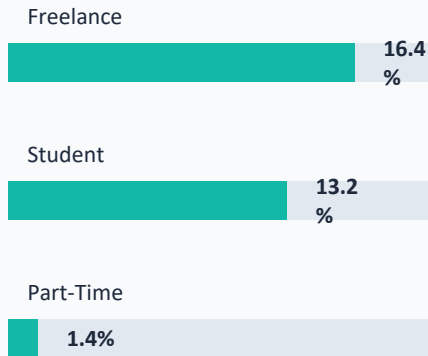
180+ countries

Source: stackoverflow.co/survey/2024/work

84% of Developers Are Working, but Full-Time Employment Dips in the U.S.



Global Non-Full-Time



U.S. non-full-time breakdown not separately tracked in 2024.

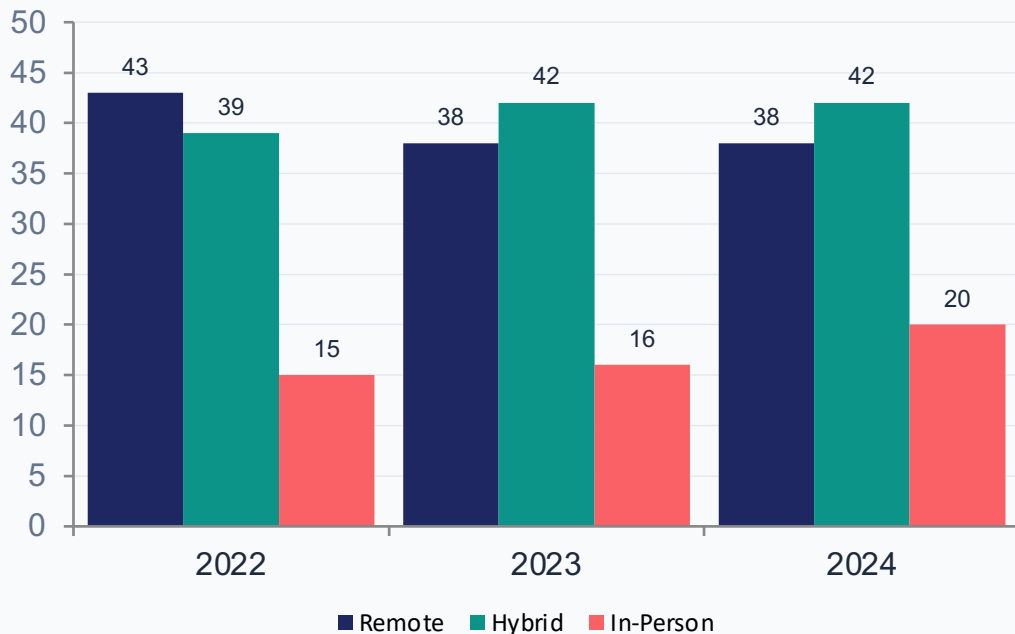
Key Insight

U.S. Full-Time Drop

69% → 64.8%

Full-time employment in the U.S. fell 4.2 percentage points year-over-year, signaling a shift toward more flexible work arrangements.

In-Person Work Rises to 20% While Hybrid Holds Steady at 42%



In-Person Rising

15% → 20%

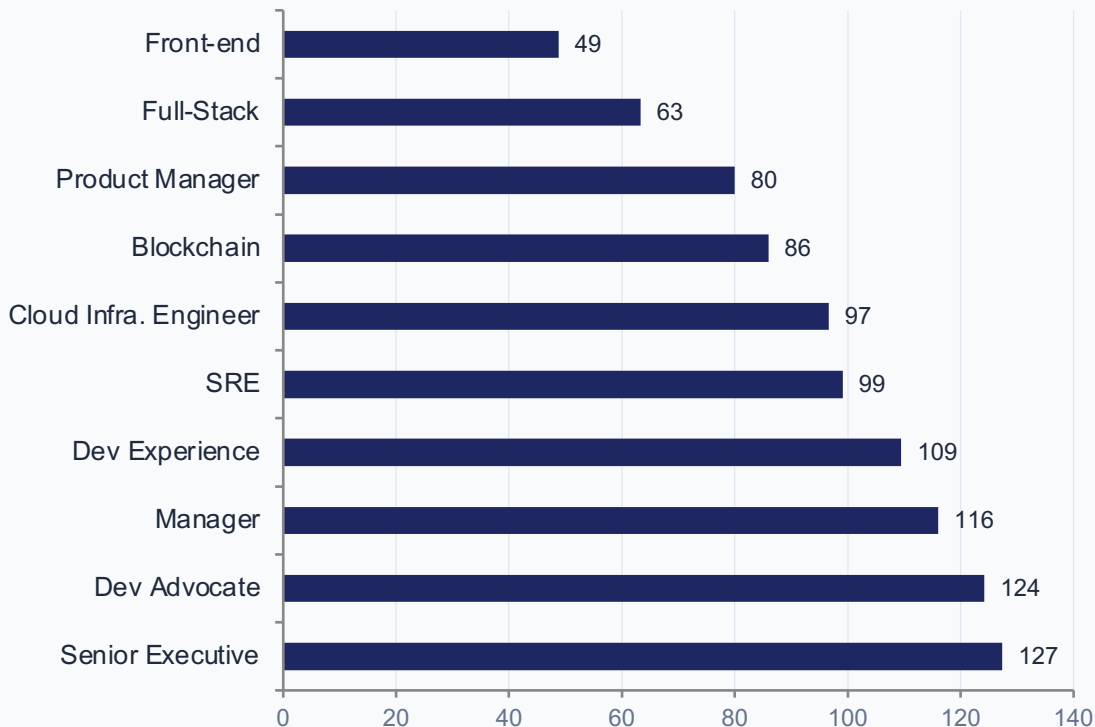
2022–2024

Hybrid Dominant

42% still hybrid

(consistent w/ 2023)

Senior Executives and Dev Advocates Top \$124K+ Median Salary



Key Insight

SRE & Cloud Infra. are highest-paid purely technical roles

SRE: \$99K

Cloud Infra: \$97K

Reflecting critical importance of keeping digital services running 24/7.

Experience Pays: Top Roles Combine 14+ Years with Six-Figure Salaries

Outlier: Student

\$15K median

2 years avg. exp.

The upper-right cluster of Senior Exec, Dev Advocate, and Manager all have 15+ years experience and \$115K+ salaries.

Bubble size $\propto$ response volume

Full-stack and Front-end roles represent the largest respondent groups, clustering toward the mid-range of experience and pay.

Erlang & Clojure Developers Earn >\$95K; Dart & Prolog Below \$45K

Top Earners

Erlang \$97K
Clojure \$95K
Elixir \$93K

Niche functional languages correlate with higher pay.

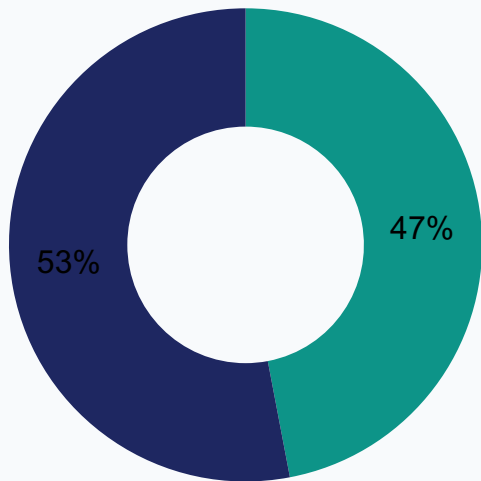
Lowest Earners

Dart \$44K
Prolog \$43K
PHP \$49K

Overall range dropped ~\$10K vs. 2023.

Avg. salary range: \$60–75K (down from \$70–85K in 2023)

47% Work at Sub-100 Orgs; 62% Influence Tech Purchases



■ < 100 employees (47%) ■ 100+ employees (53%)

47% of respondents work at organizations with fewer than 100 employees

Influence Over Tech Purchases

62% of all developers
influence tech purchasing

By Seniority



60% prefer a build-and-buy approach

75% start with a free trial to evaluate tools

73% ask other developers when evaluating new tools

Takeaways: What These Trends Mean for Hiring & Retention

1

Plan for More Contractors

U.S. full-time employment fell 4.2 pp year-over-year. Freelancing and contracting remain significant at 16%+. Build flexibility into headcount plans.

3

DevRel & SRE Command Premium Pay

Dev Advocates (\$124K), Managers (\$116K), SREs (\$99K), and Cloud Infra (\$97K) lead salaries. These critical-role retention strategies warrant investment.

5

Engage Developers in Purchase Decisions

62% of developers influence tech buying. Vendor strategies should target individual contributors and managers — not just executives.

2

Hybrid Is the Default — In-Person Is Growing

Despite rising in-person (15% → 20% since 2022), hybrid still dominates at 42%. Remote-friendly roles remain competitive differentiators.

4

Niche Languages Correlate with Higher Pay

Erlang, Clojure, and Elixir devs earn \$93K+ median. Mainstream languages (JavaScript, PHP) sit well below \$65K. Language diversity has a pay premium.